

Regional Ewaste Pathways

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Regional e-waste pathways around Dubbo

Checked 2 October 2026.

This note maps what currently happens to household e-waste in the towns and council areas around Dubbo, with a focus on practical implications for a reuse-first Dubbo e-waste/refurb operation.

Confidence key:

- [Found] current official council, NetWaste or operator source.
- [Historical] official source, but the contract/process may have changed.
- [Secondary] useful current third-party summary that cites council material, but should be confirmed directly.
- [Unknown] not established from current public sources.

Executive summary

The surrounding region already has a surprisingly broad free or low-cost council e-waste disposal network. The dominant model is:

1. resident sorts e-waste from general rubbish;
2. resident drops it at a council waste facility, transfer station or periodic bulky-waste service;
3. the council accumulates it separately;
4. a regional or council-specific recycler collects it;
5. equipment is dismantled/recycled, with some reuse where the contractor or facility has a reuse pathway.

The strongest current regional source is NetWaste, the 25-council Central and Western NSW waste group. NetWaste says Sims Metal Management collects e-waste from the majority of NetWaste councils, while several councils have individual arrangements. Its current e-waste map lists Dubbo, Wellington, Narromine, Parkes, Forbes/Darroobalgie, Warren/Ewenmar, Mudgee, Gulgong and Kandos among collection points.

That means a Dubbo business should not compete primarily on “we take e-waste”. Council already does that for many households. The gap is earlier in the hierarchy: identify reusable equipment before it becomes bulk e-waste, securely wipe it, refurbish it, resell/donate it, and send only the genuine end-of-life remainder to downstream recyclers.

There is one major limitation in the public data: it is easy to establish where residents can drop e-waste, but much harder to establish the exact current downstream processor for each council and the exact final material destinations. NetWaste's current page establishes Sims as the majority collector, but not every council-specific route.

Town-by-town / council-by-council snapshot

Area | Current public pathway | Cost / limits found | Downstream evidence | Reuse opportunity

Dubbo | Whylandra Waste & Recycling Centre accepts e-waste and old TVs; Council A-Z also directs computers, appliances, cords and USB devices to Council depots. | Domestic quantities free at Whylandra. Business/commercial terms need confirmation. | NetWaste lists Whylandra as an e-waste collection point and says Sims collects from the majority of member councils; Dubbo also has a separate local AMR pathway researched elsewhere in this repo. | High: intercept good equipment before it enters bulk recycling.

Wellington | Wellington Waste Transfer Station accepts domestic e-waste; DRC also has small CRC cabinets for phones/accessories at the Wellington administration building. | Domestic e-waste is listed among free segregated recyclables. | NetWaste lists Wellington as an e-waste collection point. Exact current contractor for this site is not publicly confirmed. | High, especially if a formal local collection/pickup partnership can be negotiated.

Geurie / Ballimore / Stuart Town and other DRC rural sites | DRC's village/rural waste page says domestic e-waste, household quantities only is accepted; exact item availability varies by site. | Free when accepted as the specified recyclable stream. Commercial/industrial loads are not accepted at these small sites. | Likely consolidated through DRC's broader regional arrangements, but exact route not published. | Small but useful feeder towns if collection is arranged before disposal.

Narromine | Narromine Waste Management Facility accepts domestic e-waste; Narromine also participates in NetWaste e-waste programs. | No charge for domestic e-waste under 2026/27 fees. | NetWaste lists Narromine Landfill as an e-waste collection point. NetWaste says Sims handles the majority of member-council e-waste. | Very relevant: close enough to Dubbo to pursue business/school collection before equipment reaches the tip.

Trangie / Tomingley | Council operates waste facilities and NetWaste recycling programs, but the current public e-waste point specifically listed by NetWaste is Narromine Landfill. | [Unknown] whether all e-waste categories can be dropped at Trangie/Tomingley today. | [Unknown] site-specific route. | Possible future collection route; confirm before advertising service there.

Gilgandra | Gilgandra Waste Facility has a CRC and a reuse/op-shop stream, but its current 2026/27 free-item list does not explicitly include e-waste, and NetWaste's current e-waste map does not list Gilgandra. | Household batteries and several problem wastes are free; e-waste status is [Unknown] from current council pages. | Historical NetWaste documents show Gilgandra participated in e-waste activity, but that is not enough to treat it as current. | Potential service gap. Call Council before assuming residents have a permanent e-waste service.

Coonamble | Council says sorted e-waste can be dropped at the Coonamble Waste Management Facility without charge. | Free when separated; mixed waste attracts charges. | Council confirms acceptance, but NetWaste's current e-waste map does not list Coonamble. Exact downstream contractor is [Unknown]. | Good candidate for periodic collection/refurb runs if transport economics work.

Gulgong | Council says sorted e-waste is accepted without charge at the waste facility. | Free when separated. | Exact downstream contractor [Unknown]. | Smaller feeder market.

Quambone | Council says sorted e-waste is accepted without charge; facility is domestic-only. | Free for sorted e-waste; commercial/industrial waste not accepted. | Exact downstream contractor [Unknown]. | Small feeder market; business collection would need a different downstream route.

Warren | Ewenmar Waste Management Facility is listed by NetWaste as an e-waste collection centre. Warren's current recycling guide says e-waste needs specialist recycling rather than the yellow bin. | Exact e-waste gate charge was not established from current council pages. | NetWaste currently lists Ewenmar and says Sims collects the majority of regional e-waste. | Potential pickup territory for higher-value devices.

Nyngan / Bogan Shire | Bogan's official pages confirm the Nyngan Waste & Resource Facility and NetWaste participation. A current secondary council-information service says domestic e-waste is free at Nyngan, but the official page surfaced in this research does not spell that out and NetWaste's current e-waste map does not list Nyngan. | [Secondary] free domestic e-waste; verify with Council. | [Unknown] current e-waste contractor. Bogan says other recyclable streams use NetWaste joint contracts. | Worth a direct call because current public information is inconsistent/incomplete.

Parkes | Parkes Waste Facility accepts sorted e-waste. Its CRC section separately says the CRC itself does not accept TVs/computers, so e-waste goes through the wider waste-facility stream, not the CRC problem-waste cages. Parkes also ran a 2026 bulky collection where e-waste was a separate kerbside pile. | 2025/26 Parkes fee schedule lists sorted e-waste as no charge. | NetWaste lists Parkes as an e-waste collection point. | Strong evidence of volume, but council already has a working disposal channel; pitch reuse/data-wipe rather than disposal.

Forbes | NetWaste lists Darroobalgie Landfill / Forbes Recycling & Waste Depot as an e-waste collection point. | Current e-waste-specific council fee not established in this pass. | NetWaste regional network; council-specific contractor not confirmed. | Secondary catchment rather than first launch area.

Mudgee | Mid-Western Regional Council specifically directs e-waste to the Tip Shop at Mudgee Waste Facility. | Council says no charges apply to domestic household waste and recycling at its waste facilities. | NetWaste lists Mudgee as an e-waste collection point. | Important comparison: this is the clearest nearby public reuse-oriented pathway, not just a disposal cage.

Gulgong | Council directs e-waste to Gulgong Waste Facility. | Domestic household waste and recycling are generally no-charge. | NetWaste lists Gulgong as an e-waste collection point. | Possible regional feeder, but distance makes direct collection less attractive initially.

Kandos | Council directs e-waste to Kandos Waste Facility. | Domestic household waste and recycling are generally no-charge. | NetWaste lists Kandos as an e-waste collection point. | Lower priority for a Dubbo pilot due to distance.

What happens after council drop-off?

1. NetWaste is the main regional coordination layer

NetWaste is a voluntary regional waste group covering 25 Central and Western NSW councils, including Dubbo Regional, Narromine, Gilgandra, Bogan, Coonamble, Warren, Parkes, Forbes and Mid-Western.

Its current e-waste page states:

Sims Metal Management collect eWaste from the majority of NetWaste Councils; several councils have individual arrangements.

That is the best current public description of the regional e-waste collection model.

Do not overstate it: this does not prove that every town above currently sends its e-waste to Sims. Some have separate arrangements, and several council pages do not name their contractor.

2. Sims' stated model is reuse + end-of-life recycling

Sims E-Recycling says it provides both reuse and recycling of redundant computers, TVs, phones and other electronics, including IT asset disposition. This supports a regional flow where at least some usable assets may be reused and the remainder dismantled/recycled.

The public Sims material does not identify the final destination of each material fraction collected from each Central West council.

3. Historical St Marys route exists, but should not be treated as current

NetWaste's 2023-2027 strategy recorded an earlier ancillary e-waste option under the regional scrap-metal contract and said e-waste was shredded at the St Marys depot, with a further recovery pilot involving E-cycle Solutions. That contract information had expiry dates around 2023 and is therefore historical evidence only.

The current NetWaste page still names Sims as the majority collector, but it does not say that the old St Marys process remains unchanged.

What this means for Dubbo E-Waste

The actual regional gap is reuse-before-recycling

Most councils already solve the disposal problem:

- residents can often drop e-waste free;
- councils segregate it;
- regional contractors remove it;
- material is recycled rather than put straight into landfill.

What is much less visible is a consistent pre-disposal reuse triage system for:

- working business laptops;
- repairable laptops/desktops;

- phones and tablets that can be unlocked/wiped;
- working monitors;
- modern flat-screen TVs;
- RAM, SSDs, chargers and other valuable components.

Mudgee's Tip Shop is the clearest nearby example where Council explicitly directs e-waste into a reuse-shop environment. Most other public pathways are framed primarily as waste/recycling services.

Do not build the business around household disposal fees

Because many councils already offer free household e-waste drop-off, charging households just to take ordinary e-waste is unlikely to be a strong proposition.

A stronger pitch is:

- free or convenient pickup of good-quality equipment;
- secure, documented data wiping;
- asset register / serial-number reporting for businesses and schools;
- refurbish and resale where viable;
- donation/redeployment options;
- revenue share or buy-back for higher-value equipment where appropriate;
- certified downstream recycling for the non-reusable remainder.

Council partnerships could be valuable, but deposited waste is not free stock

A council facility may already have contractor, ownership, WHS and site-access rules around deposited material. The business should not assume it can collect or scavenge devices after residents drop them at a waste facility.

The better partnership models to ask councils about are:

1. a signed reuse-first diversion arrangement before material enters the e-waste cage;
2. a scheduled collection day where staff direct suitable items to a separate reuse stream;
3. business/school referrals to Dubbo E-Waste before assets are taken to the tip;
4. a trial where Dubbo E-Waste reports how many devices were reused versus sent to recycling.

Priority councils to contact

For a low-cost pilot, the strongest first calls are:

1. Dubbo Regional Council – largest local stream; Whylandra + Wellington + rural sites.
2. Narromine Shire Council – confirmed free domestic e-waste and close regional fit.
3. Gilgandra Shire Council – current public e-waste pathway is unusually unclear, which may reveal a service gap.
4. Coonamble Shire Council – confirmed free sorted e-waste, but downstream route is not transparent.
5. Warren Shire Council – current NetWaste e-waste point at Ewenmar.
6. Bogan Shire Council – verify Nyngan's current e-waste rules and contractor because public sources are inconsistent.

7. Parkes Shire Council – mature collection system; useful comparison and possible reuse diversion partnership.
8. Mid-Western Regional Council – ask how its Mudgee Tip Shop triages e-waste for reuse and what happens to unsold electronics.

Questions to ask every surrounding council

Use the same short question set so answers can be compared:

1. Do you currently accept laptops, desktops, monitors, phones, tablets, printers and TVs?
2. Is it free for residents? What about business/commercial loads?
3. Which locations accept e-waste permanently?
4. Who is the current downstream contractor?
5. Is any equipment checked for reuse/refurbishment before recycling?
6. Can council legally divert suitable devices to an approved local refurbisher before they enter the recycling contract?
7. Who owns the equipment after it is dropped off?
8. Are there existing exclusivity clauses in the recycler contract?
9. Are lithium-battery devices accepted intact?
10. Can Council provide annual e-waste tonnage or item counts?
11. Would Council consider a small reuse-first pilot with serial-number tracking and diversion reporting?

Sources

Regional / NetWaste

- NetWaste — e-waste, current collection points and Sims majority-collector statement:
<https://www.netwaste.com.au/ewaste/>
- NetWaste — About Us / 25 member councils: <https://www.netwaste.com.au/about-us/>
- NetWaste — Existing regional contracts: <https://www.netwaste.com.au/projects/existing-regional-contracts/>
- NetWaste Regional Waste and Sustainable Materials Strategy 2023–2027:
https://www.netwaste.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/TW22135_NetWaste_Regional-Waste-and-Sustainable-Materials-Strategy-2023-2027_5.0.pdf
- Sims E-Recycling Australia — electronics recycling / reuse:
<https://www.simsmm.com.au/sell-to-us/electronics-recycling/>

Dubbo Regional Council

- Council waste facilities / CRCs: <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/council-waste-facilities>
- Hazardous waste / e-waste at Whylandra and Wellington:
<https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/hazardous-waste>
- Wellington Waste Transfer Station: <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/wellington-waste-transfer-station>
- Village and rural waste depots: <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/village-and-rural-waste-depots>
- A-Z Recycling: <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/Do-mestic-Waste-Services/a-z-recycling>

Narromine

- Recycling / NetWaste programs: <https://narromine.nsw.gov.au/environment/recycling>
- 2026/27 waste disposal fees — domestic e-waste no charge:
<https://www.narromine.nsw.gov.au/residents/waste-disposal-fees>

Gilgandra

- Gilgandra Waste Facility: <https://www.gilgandra.nsw.gov.au/Live/Recycling-Waste/Gilgandra-Waste-Facility>
- 2026/27 proposed/current waste-fee information and free-item list:
<https://www.gilgandra.nsw.gov.au/Stay-Connected/Have-Your-Say/Proposed-draft-Waste-Facility-Fees-Charges>
- Gilgandra CRC brochure: <https://www.gilgandra.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/1/waste-amp-recycling/welcome-to-the-gilgandra-waste-facility-brochure.pdf>

Coonamble Shire

- Coonamble Waste Management Facility: <https://coonambleshire.nsw.gov.au/residents/coonamble-waste-management-facility-1>
- Gulargambone Waste Management Facility: <https://coonambleshire.nsw.gov.au/residents/gulargambone-waste-transfer-station>
- Quambone Waste Management Facility: <https://www.coonambleshire.nsw.gov.au/residents/quambone-waste-facility>

Warren

- Ewenmar Waste Depot: <https://www.warren.nsw.gov.au/residents/waste-depot>
- Warren A-Z Recycling Guide: <https://www.warren.nsw.gov.au/kerbside-recycling/a-z-recycling-guide>

Parkes

- Waste facilities: <https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/Services/Waste-and-recycling/Waste-Facilities>
- 2025/26 waste charges including no-charge sorted e-waste:
<https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/files/assets/public/v/1/services/waste-and-recycling/garbage-and-depot-tipping-g-charges-fees-and-charges-2025-26.pdf>
- 2026 bulky waste collection / e-waste separation: <https://www.parkes.nsw.gov.au/Services/Waste-and-recycling/Waste-Collection-Days-and-Bins>

Bogan / Nyngan

- Bogan Shire bin collection and recycling: <https://bogan.nsw.gov.au/everyday-living/waste-recycling/bin-collection>
- Nyngan Waste & Resource Facility: <https://bogan.nsw.gov.au/everyday-living/waste-recycling/nyngan-waste-resource-facility>
- Secondary current summary to verify with Council: <https://councilbeacon.com.au/bogan/waste>

Mid-Western

- E-waste disposal guide: <https://www.midwestern.nsw.gov.au/Services/Bins-and-waste/Waste-guide/EWASTE>
- Waste facilities: <https://www.midwestern.nsw.gov.au/Services/Bins-and-waste/Waste-facilities>

Forbes

- NetWaste e-waste map lists Daroobalgie Landfill: <https://www.netwaste.com.au/ewaste/>

Still unknown

- Current council-by-council downstream contractor for every surrounding town.
- Whether Sims still routes this region's e-waste through St Marys specifically.
- Exact percentage of collected devices reused versus shredded/material-recovered.
- Current e-waste acceptance at Gilgandra.
- Current official Nyngan e-waste fee/acceptance wording.
- Commercial e-waste fees/limits at several council facilities.
- Whether any council contract permits a third-party refurbisher to take ownership of reusable devices before recycling.
- Annual e-waste tonnage by council and estimated proportion that is actually reusable.

Deep downstream update — 2 October 2026

Further research found several named physical routes, improving on the earlier "contractor unknown" picture.

- Parkes -> Sircel: Parkes Shire's 2024-25 progress report says e-waste from Parkes Landfill was collected by Sircel on a circular arrangement. The 2025-26 progress report records continued investigation/delivery of an e-waste shared agreement with Sircel. Sircel operates at 55 Brolgan Road, Parkes.
- What Sircel does: loads are weighed/tracked, triaged for reuse, batteries and incompatible material separated, reusable IT assets routed through ITAD/data sanitisation, and end-of-life equipment mechanically reduced/separated down to <1 mm fractions for commodity recovery. Steel, aluminium, copper and other fractions return to manufacturing/recovery partners.
- Coonamble -> Matthews Dubbo: Coonamble's February 2025 Council paper says Matthews Metals Dubbo agreed to work with Coonamble Waste for collection/disposal of e-waste and batteries. The 2026 continuation of this exact arrangement is not publicly proven.
- NetWaste majority -> Sims: NetWaste's current page still says Sims Metal Management collects e-waste from the majority of member councils. Its older 2023-27 strategy explicitly described the then e-waste option as being shredded at Sims' St Marys depot, with an E-cycle Solutions recovery trial. That St Marys detail is historical, not confirmed as the 2026 route.
- Dubbo remains unresolved: DRC's historical Matthews contract ended 30 June 2025. The current public Council pages do not identify the 2026 processor, so it is not safe to assume Whylandra material goes to AMR, Sims or Sircel without confirmation.
- Separate scrap-metal change: the late-2025 NetWaste scrap-metal tender F4459 was awarded to Access Recycling by participating councils. This does not prove Access took over e-waste; NetWaste still names Sims on its current e-waste page.

For the detailed device-to-material flow, data handling, NTCRS rules and real recovery numbers, see WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md (WHAT-HAPPENS-TO-EWASTE.md).

Closest-town reuse/resale update — 2 October 2026

A separate official-program review of Dubbo, Wellington, Narromine and Trangie found:

- Dubbo: full e-waste recycling access; reuse shops have been planned/business-cased, but no operating electronics-specific test/wipe/refurbish/resale program was verified.

- Wellington: full e-waste collection; reuse-shop concept included in Council planning; no verified operating electronics reuse service.
- Narromine: domestic e-waste no charge; Council promotes reuse through Garage Sale Trail. The 2024-25 Annual Report records 47 sales/stalls and 4,231 items reused or sold.
- Trangie: current documented electronics program is smaller and focused on small-item recycling; no specialist electronics reuse/resale program was verified.

See:

- DUBBO-WELLINGTON-NARROMINE-TRANGIE-REUSE-PROGRAMS.md
(DUBBO-WELLINGTON-NARROMINE-TRANGIE-REUSE-PROGRAMS.md)
- WHY-COUNCIL-ELECTRONICS-REUSE-IS-HARD.md (WHY-COUNCIL-ELECTRONICS-REUSE-IS-HARD.md)

The strategic implication is unchanged but stronger:

Do not compete with councils on disposal. Build the pre-disposal electronics reuse layer they are not currently structured to provide.